

Day 80 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in History & National Movement (5): 86th Anniversary of the Forward Bloc's Nagpur Conference

READING MATERIAL

Covers the All India Forward Bloc's founding and its first plenary conference at Nagpur (June 1940) — marking its 86th anniversary in June 2026.

Q: Who founded the All India Forward Bloc, and when?

A: Subhas Chandra Bose, in May 1939 — after he resigned as Indian National Congress President (following conflict with the Gandhian leadership after the Tripuri Congress session) and formed Forward Bloc initially as a left-wing faction within the Congress.

Q: Where and when was the Forward Bloc's first plenary conference held, marking its 86th anniversary in 2026?

A: At Nagpur, in June 1940 (sources vary on the exact dates — either 18-22 or 20-22 June 1940).

Q: What was the significance of the Nagpur plenary conference for the Forward Bloc?

A: It transformed the Forward Bloc from a Congress faction into an INDEPENDENT socialist political party, committed to a militant, anti-imperialist programme.

Q: What was the key resolution/slogan that emerged from the Nagpur conference?

A: The resolution 'All Power to the Indian People' — Bose's rallying cry moving past standard constitutional demands toward urging militant action against British colonial rule.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The All India Forward Bloc was founded by Subhas Chandra Bose in:

- A. 1937
- B. 1939 ✓**
- C. 1940
- D. 1942

Explanation: May 1939. [medium, web-research]

2. The Forward Bloc's first plenary conference (its 86th anniversary fell in June 2026) was held at:

- A. Nagpur ✓**
- B. Lucknow
- C. Haripura
- D. Tripuri

Explanation: Nagpur, June 1940. [medium, web-research]

3. The Nagpur plenary conference (June 1940) transformed the Forward Bloc into:

- A. A wing of the Muslim League
- B. An independent socialist, anti-imperialist political party ✓**
- C. A purely cultural organisation
- D. A British-recognised constitutional body

Explanation: An independent socialist, anti-imperialist political party. [medium, web-research]

4. What rallying resolution emerged from the Nagpur conference?

- A. Do or Die
- B. All Power to the Indian People ✓**
- C. Swaraj is my birthright
- D. Inquilab Zindabad

Explanation: All Power to the Indian People. [hard, web-research]

5. Subhas Chandra Bose resigned as Congress President and formed the Forward Bloc following conflict after which Congress session?

- A. Lahore session

B. Tripuri session ✓

C. Haripura session

D. Karachi session

Explanation: Tripuri Congress session. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Number Series

READING MATERIAL

Number Series is the final Reasoning skill. Real exam evidence shows 6 distinct underlying patterns: second-difference (difference-of-differences) sequences, sum-of-consecutive-cubes, geometric progression, arithmetic progression, n^2 multiples, and prime-number-squared sequences — recognize the pattern TYPE before trying to compute term-by-term.

Q: Method — sum of consecutive cubes: Find the next term: 9, 35, 91, ?

A: Each term is $n^3 + (n+1)^3$: $1^3 + 2^3 = 1 + 8 = 9$ ✓, $2^3 + 3^3 = 8 + 27 = 35$ ✓, $3^3 + 4^3 = 27 + 64 = 91$ ✓. Next: $4^3 + 5^3 = 64 + 125 = 189$.

Q: Method — second-difference (arithmetic sequence of differences): Fill in the blank: 1, 6, 15, 28, 45, ____, 91.

A: Differences: $6 - 1 = 5$, $15 - 6 = 9$, $28 - 15 = 13$, $45 - 28 = 17$ — these differences themselves increase by 4 each time. Next difference = $17 + 4 = 21$, so the blank = $45 + 21 = 66$. (Check: $91 - 66 = 25 = 21 + 4$ ✓ consistent.)

Q: Method — sequence of squared primes: Find the missing number in the sequence of squared prime numbers: 4 (2^2), 9 (3^2), 25 (5^2), 49 (7^2), ?, 169 (13^2).

A: The base numbers are consecutive primes: 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13. The missing term corresponds to $11^2 = 121$. (Caution: the original source rendered this sequence with garbled formatting that looked like plain 3-digit numbers rather than squared primes — always re-derive the actual pattern rather than trusting a confusing transcription.)

Q: Method — simple arithmetic progression (AP) with increasing-by-2 differences: Find the next term: 1, 5, 11, 19, 29, ?

A: Differences: 4, 6, 8, 10 — increasing by 2 each time. Next difference = 12, so next term = $29 + 12 = 41$.

Q: Method — geometric progression (GP): Find the 8th term of 2, 6, 18, 54, ...

A: Common ratio = 3 (each term $\times 3$). Terms: 2, 6, 18, 54, 162, 486, 1458, 4374. The 8th term is 4,374.

Q: Method — plain arithmetic progression, nth term formula: Find the 20th term of 7, 10, 13, ...

A: First term = 7, common difference = 3. nth term = $a + (n-1)d = 7 + (19 \times 3) = 7 + 57 = 64$.

Q: Method — multiples of n^2 : Find the missing number: 3, 12, 27, 48, 75, 108, ____.

A: Each term = $3 \times n^2$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$: $3 \times 1 = 3$, $3 \times 4 = 12$, $3 \times 9 = 27$, $3 \times 16 = 48$, $3 \times 25 = 75$, $3 \times 36 = 108$. Next ($n=7$): $3 \times 49 = 147$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the next term: 2, 9, 28, 65, 126, ?

A. 215

B. 217 ✓

C. 219

D. 221

Explanation: Each term is $n^3 + 1$: $1^3 + 1 = 2$, $2^3 + 1 = 9$, $3^3 + 1 = 28$, $4^3 + 1 = 65$, $5^3 + 1 = 126$. Next: $6^3 + 1 = 216 + 1 = 217$. [hard, authored]

2. Fill in the blank: 2, 7, 14, 23, 34, ____, 62.

A. 45

B. 47 ✓

C. 49

D. 51

Explanation: Differences: 5, 7, 9, 11 — increasing by 2. Next difference = 13, so blank = $34 + 13 = 47$. (Check: $62 - 47 = 15 = 13 + 2$, consistent.) [medium, authored]

3. Find the next term: 3, 7, 15, 27, 43, ?

A. 61

B. 63 ✓

C. 65

D. 67

Explanation: Differences: 4, 8, 12, 16 — increasing by 4. Next difference = 20, so next term = $43 + 20 = 63$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the 7th term of the GP: 3, 9, 27, 81, ...

A. 1,458

B. 2,187 ✓

C. 2,287

D. 1,987

Explanation: Common ratio 3: 3,9,27,81,243,729,2187. 7th term = 2,187. [medium, authored]

5. Find the 15th term of the AP: 5, 9, 13, 17, ...

A. 59

B. 61 ✓

C. 63

D. 65

Explanation: $a=5$, $d=4$. 15th term = $5+(14 \times 4) = 5+56 = 61$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the missing number: 2, 8, 18, 32, 50, ____.

A. 62

B. 68

C. 72 ✓

D. 78

Explanation: Each term = $2 \times n^2$: $2 \times 1=2$, $2 \times 4=8$, $2 \times 9=18$, $2 \times 16=32$, $2 \times 25=50$. Next ($n=6$): $2 \times 36=72$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Direct and Indirect (Reported) Speech

READING MATERIAL

Converting direct speech to indirect (reported) speech requires 3 simultaneous changes: (1) backshift the tense (present→past, etc.), (2) change pronouns to match the reporter's perspective, (3) restructure based on sentence type (statement/question/command).

Q: Convert to indirect speech: He said, "I am reading a book."

A: He said he was reading a book. (Present continuous 'am reading' backshifts to past continuous 'was reading'; 'I' → 'he'.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: She said, "I have finished my work."

A: She said she had finished her work. (Present perfect 'have finished' backshifts to past perfect 'had finished'.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: He said, "I will go to Chennai tomorrow."

A: He said he would go to Chennai the next day. ('will' → 'would'; the time reference 'tomorrow' must also shift to 'the next day', since it's no longer being said on that same day.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: 'Where are you going?' she asked.

A: She asked where I was going. (WH-questions drop the question mark and word order inversion, becoming a statement clause introduced directly by the WH-word — NOT 'where was I going', which wrongly keeps the inverted question word order.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: "Do you speak English?" he asked.

A: He asked if I spoke English. (Yes/no questions — with no WH-word — are introduced with 'if' or 'whether', not reported directly as a question.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: The teacher said, "Be quiet."

A: The teacher told us to be quiet. (Imperatives/commands use 'told [someone] to' + base verb — not 'asked to' alone, which is missing the object, and not 'advised us be quiet', which is missing the infinitive 'to'.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: He said, "Let us go for a walk."

A: He said that they should go for a walk. (Note: a more natural alternative — 'He suggested they go for a walk' — sounds equally correct in everyday English, but the source exam's marked answer specifically used 'said that...should', so match the exact pattern asked for.)

Q: Convert to indirect speech: They said, "We are watching a movie."

A: They said they were watching a movie. (Present continuous → past continuous; 'we' → 'they', matching the subject already established by 'They said'.)

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. He said, "I am reading a book." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. He said he is reading a book.

B. He said he was reading a book. ✓

C. He said I was reading a book.

D. He said I read a book.

Explanation: He said he was reading a book. [easy, web-research]

2. She said, "I have finished my work." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. She said she finished her work.

B. She said she had finished her work. ✓

C. She said I have finished work.

D. She says she has finished her work.

Explanation: She said she had finished her work. [medium, web-research]

3. He said, "I will go to Chennai tomorrow." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. He said he would go to Chennai the next day. ✓

B. He said he will go to Chennai the next day.

C. He said he goes to Chennai tomorrow.

D. He said he would go Chennai tomorrow.

Explanation: He said he would go to Chennai the next day. [medium, web-research]

4. 'Where are you going?' she asked. (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. She asked where I was going. ✓

B. She asked where was I going.

C. She asked where am I going.

D. She asked where I going.

Explanation: She asked where I was going. [medium, web-research]

5. "Do you speak English?" he asked. (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. He asked if I spoke English. ✓

B. He asked if I had spoken English.

C. He asked do I speak English.

D. He said if I spoke English.

Explanation: He asked if I spoke English. [medium, web-research]

6. The teacher said, "Be quiet." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. The teacher asked to be quiet.

B. The teacher told us to be quiet. ✓

C. The teacher advised us be quiet.

D. The teacher told to be quiet.

Explanation: The teacher told us to be quiet. [medium, web-research]

7. He said, "Let us go for a walk." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. He said that they should go for a walk. ✓

B. He said let's go for a walk.

C. He suggested we go for a walk.

D. He said that we go for a walk.

Explanation: He said that they should go for a walk. [hard, web-research]

8. They said, "We are watching a movie." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. They said they are watching a movie.

B. They said they had watched a movie.

C. They said they were watching a movie. ✓

D. They said we are watching a movie.

Explanation: They said they were watching a movie. [medium, web-research]

9. "Why are you crying?" asked the mother. (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. The mother asked why I cried.

B. The mother asked why was I crying.

C. The mother asked why I was crying. ✓

D. The mother asked why are you crying.

Explanation: The mother asked why I was crying. [medium, web-research]

10. He said, "I met him yesterday." (Convert to indirect speech.)

A. He said he had met him the previous day. ✓

B. He said he met him yesterday.

C. He said I met him the day before.

D. He said he meets him that day.

Explanation: He said he had met him the previous day. [hard, web-research]